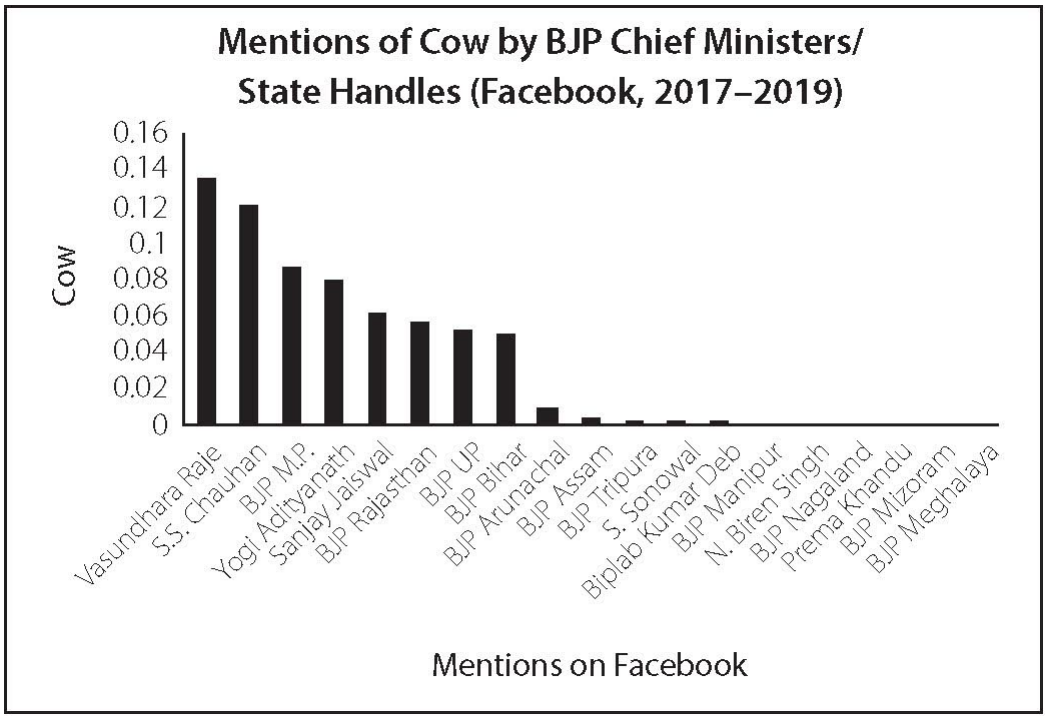
increased budgets for cow shelters.[46] Vasundhara Raje declared that in Rajasthan, during her tenure, cow-protection measures had increased the number of these animals in cowsheds by three times.[47] In Madhya Pradesh, Shivraj Singh Chouhan, while in Opposition, questioned the Congress state government in 2019 about its election promise to build more cowsheds. The Congress's failure to build them after promising to do so, he said, amounted to a 'sin like cow killing'.[48]

Figure 16.4: A Comparison of 'Cow' Mentions by BJP Chief Ministers/State Handles in Hindi-speaking States vs BJP Chief Ministers/Handles in the Northeast on Facebook



Source: Narad Index, Nalin Mehta and Rishabh Srivastava; for more details, see Appendix 4/online at nalinmehta.in

The BJP's Facebook handles in Hindi-speaking states promoted this aggressively, while its Facebook handles in the Northeast stayed away from the issue entirely (see Figure 16.5). Occasionally, when such controversies challenged BJP narratives, party chief ministers like Pema Khandu of Arunachal Pradesh pushed back, saying that